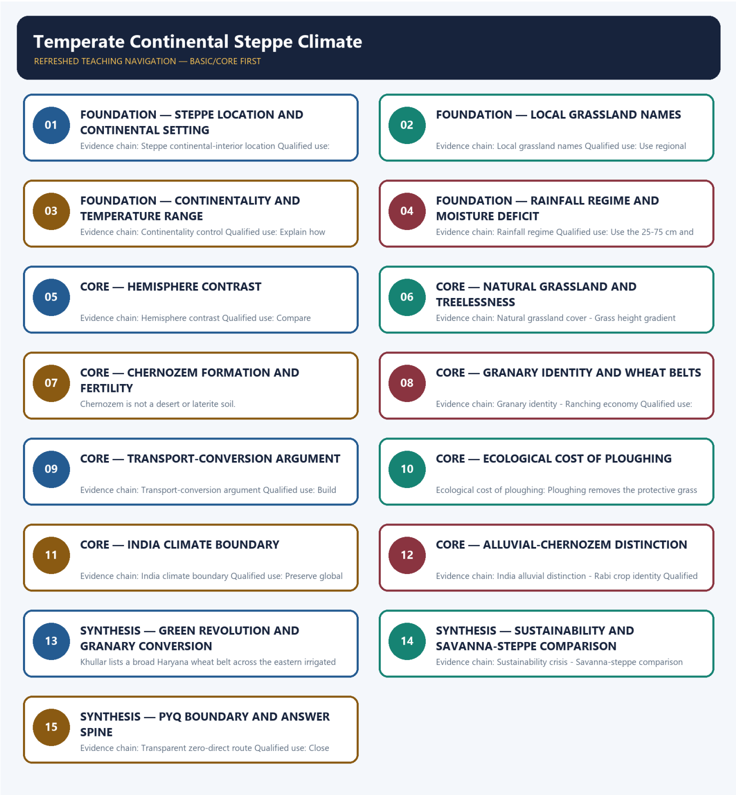
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Temperate Continental Steppe Climate - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Temperate Continental Steppe Climate - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Steppe continental-interior location?

A. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. B. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. C. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. D. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest.

Answer: A. Explanation: The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Steppe continental-interior location?

A. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. B. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. C. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. D. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime.

Answer: B. Explanation: The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Steppe continental-interior location?

A. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. B. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. C. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. D. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime.

Answer: C. Explanation: The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Steppe continental-interior location?

A. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. B. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. C. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. D. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia.

Answer: D. Explanation: The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly explains Local grassland names?

A. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. B. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. C. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. D. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest.

Answer: A. Explanation: The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Local grassland names?

A. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. B. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. C. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. D. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity.

Answer: B. Explanation: The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Local grassland names?

A. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. B. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. C. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. D. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone.

Answer: C. Explanation: The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. The other options describe different processes, locations,

scales or governance categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Local grassland names?

A. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. B. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. C. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. D. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer.

Answer: D. Explanation: The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly explains Continentality control?

A. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. B. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. C. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. D. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Continentality control?

A. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. B. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. C. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. D. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest.

Answer: B. Explanation: The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Continentality control?

A. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. B. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. C. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. D. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone.

Answer: C. Explanation: The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or

governance categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Continentality control?

A. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. B. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. C. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. D. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest.

Answer: D. Explanation: The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly explains Rainfall regime?

A. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. B. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. C. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. D. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Rainfall regime?

A. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. B. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. C. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. D. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Rainfall regime?

A. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. B. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. C. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. D. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Rainfall regime?

A. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. B. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. C. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. D. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly explains Hemisphere contrast?

A. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. B. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. C. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. D. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Answer: A. Explanation: Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Hemisphere contrast?

A. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. B. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. C. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. D. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Hemisphere contrast?

A. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. B. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. C. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. D. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Answer: C. Explanation: Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Hemisphere contrast?

A. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. B. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. C. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. D. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime.

Answer: D. Explanation: Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly explains Natural grassland cover?

A. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. B. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. C. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. D. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Answer: A. Explanation: Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Natural grassland cover?

A. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. B. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. C. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. D. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production.

Answer: B. Explanation: Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Natural grassland cover?

A. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. B. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. C. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. D. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Natural grassland cover?

A. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. B. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. C. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. D. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly explains Grass height gradient?

A. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. B. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. C. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. D. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Answer: A. Explanation: Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Grass height gradient?

A. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. B. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. C. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. D. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production.

Answer: B. Explanation: Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Grass height gradient?

A. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. B. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. C. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. D. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production.

Answer: C. Explanation: Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Grass height gradient?

A. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. B. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. C. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. D. Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest.

Answer: D. Explanation: Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly explains Chernozem and prairie soils?

A. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. B. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. C. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. D. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production.

Answer: A. Explanation: Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Chernozem and prairie soils?

A. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. B. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. C. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. D. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production.

Answer: B. Explanation: Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Chernozem and prairie soils?

A. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. B. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. C. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. D. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary.

Answer: C. Explanation: Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Chernozem and prairie soils?

A. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. B. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. C. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. D. Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Answer: D. Explanation: Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly explains Granary identity?

A. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. B. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. C. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. D. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence.

Answer: A. Explanation: The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Granary identity?

A. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. B. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. C. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. D. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added.

Answer: B. Explanation: The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Granary identity?

A. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. B. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. C. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. D. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different.

Answer: C. Explanation: The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Granary identity?

A. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. B. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. C. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. D. The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly explains Ranching economy?

A. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. B. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. C. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. D. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence.

Answer: A. Explanation: These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Ranching economy?

A. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. B. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. C. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. D. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary.

Answer: B. Explanation: These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production.

The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Ranching economy?

A. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. B. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. C. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. D. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary.

Answer: C. Explanation: These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Ranching economy?

A. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. B. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. C. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. D. These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production.

Answer: D. Explanation: These grasslands also support commercial grazing and ranching on a large scale, with temperate grasslands alongside tropical savannas as leading areas of extensive livestock production. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly explains Transport-conversion argument?

A. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. B. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. C. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. D. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary.

Answer: A. Explanation: The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Transport-conversion argument?

A. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. B. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. C. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. D. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different.

Answer: B. Explanation: The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Transport-conversion argument?

A. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. B. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. C. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. D. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season.

Answer: C. Explanation: The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Transport-conversion argument?

A. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. B. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. C. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. D. The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence.

Answer: D. Explanation: The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly explains Ecological cost of ploughing?

A. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. B. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. C. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. D. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Ecological cost of ploughing?

A. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. B. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. C. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. D. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Ecological cost of ploughing?

A. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. B. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. C. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. D. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Ecological cost of ploughing?

A. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. B. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. C. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. D. Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly explains India climate boundary?

A. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. B. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. C. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. D. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different.

Answer: A. Explanation: India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India climate boundary?

A. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. B. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. C. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. D. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list.

Answer: B. Explanation: India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India climate boundary?

A. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. B. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. C. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. D. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list.

Answer: C. Explanation: India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India climate boundary?

A. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. B. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. C. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. D. India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary.

Answer: D. Explanation: India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly explains India alluvial distinction?

A. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. B. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. C. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. D. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text.

Answer: A. Explanation: India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India alluvial distinction?

A. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. B. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. C. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. D. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt.

Answer: B. Explanation: India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India alluvial distinction?

A. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. B. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. C. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. D. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them.

Answer: C. Explanation: India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India alluvial distinction?

A. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. B. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. C. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. D. India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different.

Answer: D. Explanation: India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly explains Green Revolution package?

A. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. B. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. C. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. D. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Green Revolution package?

A. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. B. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. C. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. D. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Green Revolution package?

A. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. B. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. C. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. D. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Green Revolution package?

A. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. B. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. C. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. D. The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly explains Rabi crop identity?

A. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. B. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. C. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. D. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt.

Answer: A. Explanation: Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Rabi crop identity?

A. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. B. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. C. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. D. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated.

Answer: B. Explanation: Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Rabi crop identity?

A. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. B. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. C. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. D. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them.

Answer: C. Explanation: Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Rabi crop identity?

A. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. B. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. C. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. D. Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season.

Answer: D. Explanation: Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly explains Haryana wheat belt?

A. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. B. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. C. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. D. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt.

Answer: A. Explanation: Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Haryana wheat belt?

A. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. B. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. C. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. D. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated.

Answer: B. Explanation: Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Haryana wheat belt?

A. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. B. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. C. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. D. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer.

Answer: C. Explanation: Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Haryana wheat belt?

A. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. B. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. C. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. D. Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list.

Answer: D. Explanation: Khullar lists a broad Haryana wheat belt across the eastern irrigated districts and central-western plains; district names and boundaries from older editions should not be treated as a current exhaustive list. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly explains Sustainability crisis?

A. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. B. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. C. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. D. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia.

Answer: A. Explanation: Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Sustainability crisis?

A. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. B. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. C. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. D. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer.

Answer: B. Explanation: Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Sustainability crisis?

A. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. B. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. C. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. D. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer.

Answer: C. Explanation: Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Sustainability crisis?

A. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. B. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. C. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. D. Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt.

Answer: D. Explanation: Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly explains Savanna-steppe comparison?

A. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. B. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia. C. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. D. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated.

Answer: A. Explanation: Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Savanna-steppe comparison?

A. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. B. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. C. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. D. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia.

Answer: B. Explanation: Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Savanna-steppe comparison?

A. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. B. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. C. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. D. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity.

Answer: C. Explanation: Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Savanna-steppe comparison?

A. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. B. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. C. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. D. Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them.

Answer: D. Explanation: Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly explains Transparent zero-direct route?

A. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. B. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. C. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer. D. The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Transparent zero-direct route?

A. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest. B. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. C. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. D. The biome is named differently by region: steppes in Eurasia, prairies in USA and Canada, pampas in Argentina and Uruguay, veld in South Africa and downs in Australia; all share nutritious grasses that flower in spring and early summer.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Transparent zero-direct route?

A. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. B. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. C. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. D. The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Transparent zero-direct route?

A. Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime. B. Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity. C. Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone. D. The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20; steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture questions but no solved PYQ is fabricated. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

The audited routing ledgers contain no direct question owned by Geography Topic 20. Steppe and granary concepts may be tested through adjacent climate-agriculture cross-owner questions, but no solved PYQ or fabricated answer key is included.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why temperate continental interiors are treeless grasslands despite fertile soils. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Treelessness is a moisture-deficit and disturbance outcome from continentality, fire and grazing, not a soil-fertility outcome; the chernozem soils are among the most fertile in the world.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The temperate continental or steppe climate occurs in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts and far from maritime influence, with major expressions in Eurasia, North America, South America, South Africa and Australia.
- Natural cover is grassland, practically treeless, with tree scarcity controlled by seasonal moisture deficit, continentality, fire and grazing rather than by poor soil alone.
- Steppe and prairie soils such as chernozem or black earth are humus-rich because of centuries of grass-root decay under low leaching, and are among the most fertile agricultural soils in the world.

Qualified conclusion: Treelessness is a moisture-deficit and disturbance outcome from continentality, fire and grazing, not a soil-fertility outcome; the chernozem soils are among the most fertile in the world.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Compare the steppe and pampas in terms of climate severity and maritime influence. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Northern hemisphere steppes have more extreme temperatures because of larger continental mass, while southern hemisphere pampas are moderated by surrounding ocean and narrower landmass.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The controlling factor is continentality: distance from the sea produces hot summers, cold winters and a large annual temperature range, especially in northern hemisphere interiors where continental mass is greatest.

- Northern hemisphere steppes and prairies experience more extreme temperatures than southern hemisphere pampas, veld and downs because southern continents are narrower and more maritime.
- Rainfall is low to moderate, about 25 to 75 centimetres annually, with most falling in late spring and early summer; the defining character is moisture deficit rather than extreme aridity.

Qualified conclusion: Northern hemisphere steppes have more extreme temperatures because of larger continental mass, while southern hemisphere pampas are moderated by surrounding ocean and narrower landmass.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain why the temperate grasslands became the world's granaries and what ecological cost this conversion carried. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Chernozem fertility, level relief and mechanisation provided the physical base, but rail, freight and market demand were the converting agents; ploughing removed the protective sod and created wind-erosion and aquifer risks.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation.
- The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence.
- Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added.

Qualified conclusion: Chernozem fertility, level relief and mechanisation provided the physical base, but rail, freight and market demand were the converting agents; ploughing removed the protective sod and created wind-erosion and aquifer risks.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess how India's Indo-Gangetic wheat granary compares with the world's temperate steppe granaries. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: India's wheat belt shares the granary function but sits on alluvial soil, relies on the Rabi season, and was transformed by the Green Revolution package rather than by rail-and-mechanisation alone.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- India has no true temperate-steppe wheat climate like Eurasia's chernozem grasslands, but the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plain, especially Punjab-Haryana-western Uttar Pradesh, plays the equivalent economic role as India's wheat granary.
- India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different.
- The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text.
- Wheat is a Rabi or winter crop in India, sown October to December and harvested March to April, which is the seasonal reverse of the northern-hemisphere temperate summer growing season.

Qualified conclusion: India's wheat belt shares the granary function but sits on alluvial soil, relies on the Rabi season, and was transformed by the Green Revolution package rather than by rail-and-mechanisation alone.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse the transport-conversion argument as a counter to environmental determinism in the temperate grasslands. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The grasslands were pastoral or unexploited for centuries despite identical soils and became granaries only when railways, mechanisation and ocean freight connected them to distant markets; this is the strongest evidence that physical endowment requires institutional access to become a resource.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The physical endowment did not create the granaries by itself: rail penetration, ocean freight, mechanisation and external market demand converted pastoral or unexploited interiors into surplus wheat suppliers, which is the strongest available counter to environmental determinism in this climate sequence.
- The temperate grasslands are the granaries of the world, with major wheat belts in the Ukrainian steppe, North American prairies and Argentine pampas, supported by level relief permitting mechanisation.
- Grass is shorter toward the desert margin and taller toward the wetter margin, reflecting a moisture gradient that also controls the boundary between steppe and forest.
- Ploughing removes the protective grass sod, exposing fine soil to wind erosion in drought years; consequences include the Dust Bowl analogy, organic-matter decline and aquifer drawdown where irrigation was added.

Qualified conclusion: The grasslands were pastoral or unexploited for centuries despite identical soils and became granaries only when railways, mechanisation and ocean freight connected them to distant markets; this is the strongest evidence that physical endowment requires institutional access to become a resource.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Design a sustainability strategy for the Punjab-Haryana wheat-rice system using the steppe-conversion lesson. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The steppe lesson shows that converting a natural grassland into a monoculture granary carries predictable ecological costs; apply conservation tillage, crop diversification, groundwater regulation and MSP reform to the Indo-Gangetic system.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Intensive wheat-rice systems in Punjab-Haryana have sustainability costs including groundwater depletion, soil-nutrient imbalance and stubble-burning; MSP procurement concentrates these pressures in a narrow belt.
- The Green Revolution package of HYV semi-dwarf wheat, fertiliser, assured canal and tube-well irrigation and MSP procurement transformed the north-western plains into a surplus granary, with Punjab described as a major food basket region in the source text.
- India's wheat belt sits on Indo-Gangetic alluvial soil, not black chernozem like the steppe; the economic analogy holds but the pedological basis is fundamentally different.
- Both the savanna and the steppe are grasslands, but tropical versus temperate latitude, wet-and-dry versus low-total-with-summer-maximum rainfall, leached laterising versus base-rich chernozem soils, and pastoral-subsistence versus mechanised-commercial grain distinguish them.

Qualified conclusion: The steppe lesson shows that converting a natural grassland into a monoculture granary carries predictable ecological costs; apply conservation tillage, crop diversification, groundwater regulation and MSP reform to the Indo-Gangetic system.